



Individual Instructor Report Spring 2024 Version A for STA 301 - INTRODUCTION TO DATA SCIENCE (05150) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Spring 2024**

Courses Audience: **55**

Responses Received: **23**

Response Ratio: **41.8%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

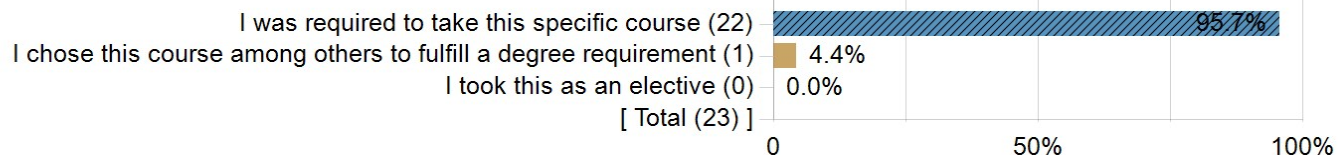
The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

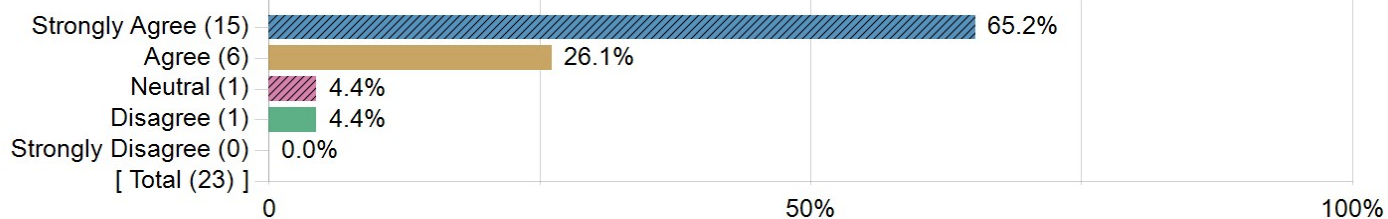
Creation Date: **Friday, June 14, 2024**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?

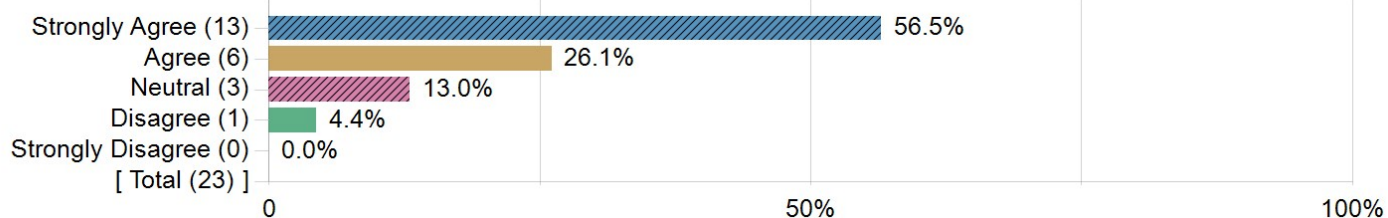


During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



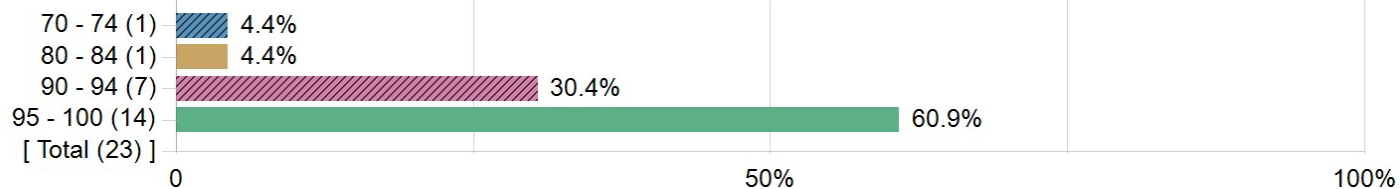
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.52

The course was well organized.



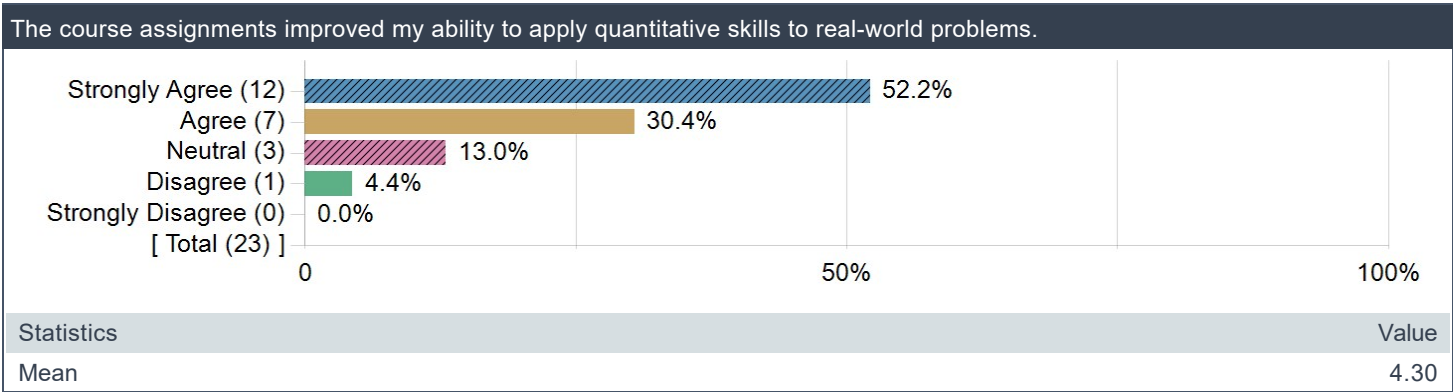
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.35

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



Statistics	Value
Mean	94.00

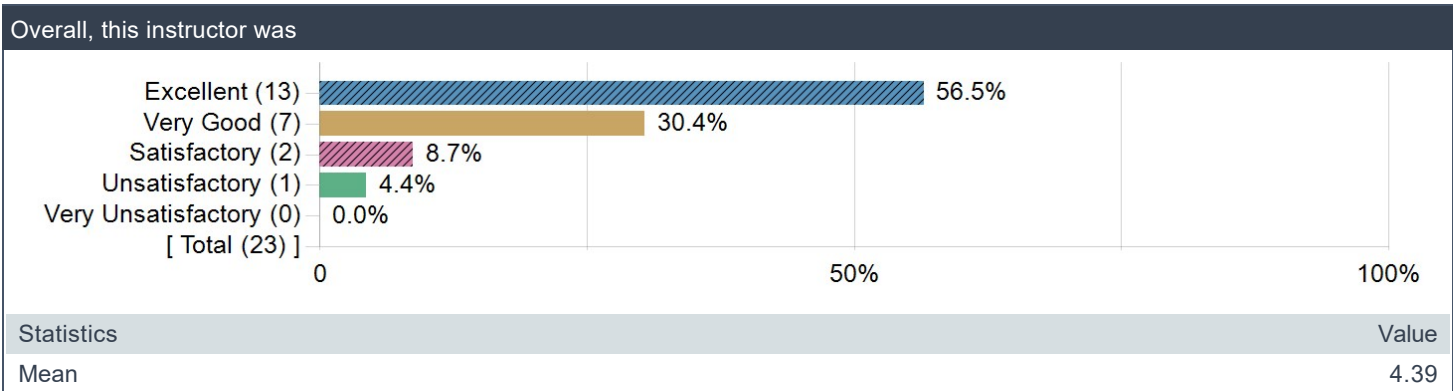
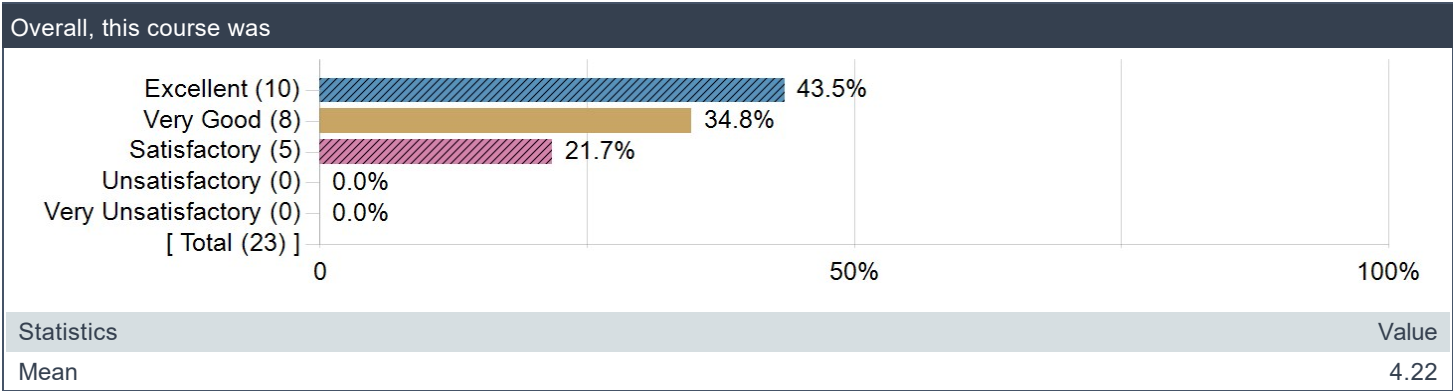
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



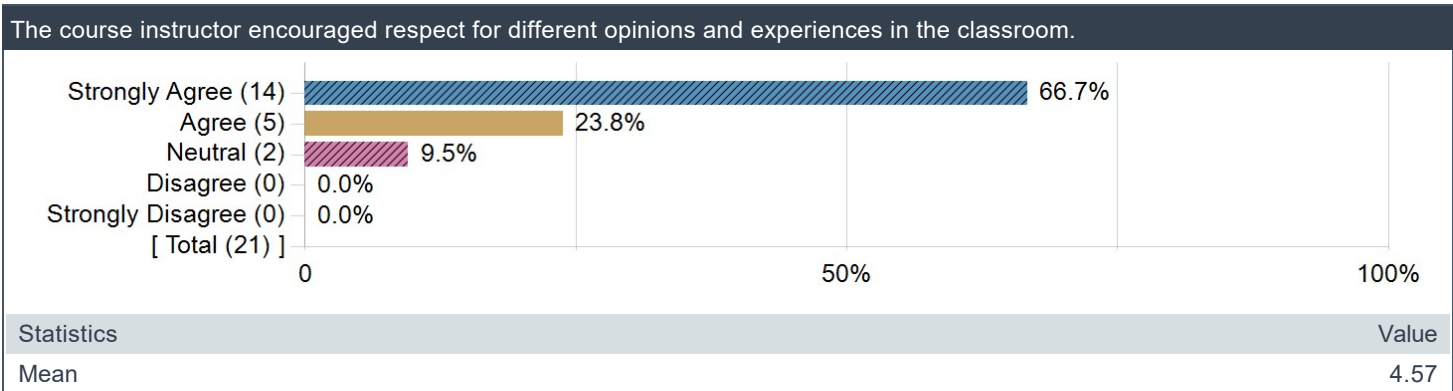
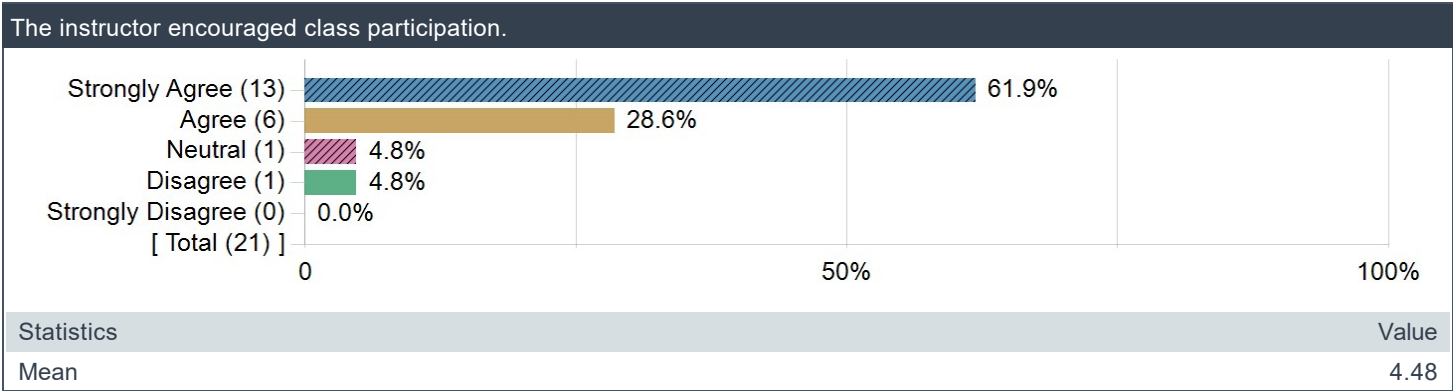
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	65.2%	13.0%	21.7%	0.0%	0.0%	23	4.43
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	69.6%	17.4%	13.0%	0.0%	0.0%	23	4.57
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	65.2%	13.0%	21.7%	0.0%	0.0%	23	4.43
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	56.5%	21.7%	13.0%	8.7%	0.0%	23	4.26
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	60.9%	26.1%	13.0%	0.0%	0.0%	23	4.48

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
The instructor did a great job at explaining concepts and answering questions effectively.
The class says and TA hours.
I think that the TA office hours and R session were amazing.
amazing
The r session helped me learn how to use R effectively.
R sessions and Knowledge Checks
–
Textbook was most helpful
the kcs, and lectures
Having class recordings and KC checks
Like just about none.
The KC
Lectures were excellent and the KC's were great practice.
The textbook and PowerPoints
His teaching style and readiness to help.
The instructor was passionate about the course and was consistent in how he taught class.
Bolfarine was very nice and provided a clear understanding of the material.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
The material was the most challenging and keeping up with all the knowledge checks and homework assignments.
The homework were very tedious and the test were hard. Maybe have one less homework
The most challenging part is using R studio for coding especially with no coding background. I'd say this portion of the class which is about 90% of the class is much harder for me than the actual statistics part.
really good
Grading homework seemed to be weird because some people would just take off points for random things but it wasn't worth going through the process of getting an appeal.
The final being cumulative was really difficult. This class is content heavy and a cumulative final was very challenging.
–
R coding is really hard, tough class
the midterm, more practice test
The midterm was too short for time– consistently stressed about time versus understanding the questions
I thought the entire class was challenging and there are so many ways it could be approached better.
The most challenging were the hws
The homework assignments were fairly challenging. They could be a little more spread out/less backloaded.
The exams and the amount of concepts
The material itself was quite challenging but Bolfarine taught us very well.
Sometimes I felt like conceptual concepts weren't covered as much as just examples.
I've never taken statistics so this class was already hard to start off with but the reading amount was hard for me to follow.